

SUPERSTORE SALES & PROFIT ANALYSIS — KEY INSIGHTS & RECOMMENDATIONS

Dataset: US Superstore 2014–2017 | Analyst: Jyoti Gupta | Date: May 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Superstore business generated \$2.29M in sales with a 12.47% profit margin across 2014–2017. Technology emerged as the strongest category with 17.4% margins, while Furniture critically underperformed due to losses in Tables and Bookcases. Sales peak in Q4, particularly November, highlighting strong seasonal demand

FINDING 1 — Technology is the star category

Insight: Technology generates \$836K in sales with \$145K profit — a 17.4% margin, the highest of all three categories.

Recommendation:

- Prioritize Copiers and Phones — they drive 35% of total profit
- Increase Technology inventory and marketing budget
- Expand Technology offerings in underperforming regions

FINDING 2 — Furniture is a silent profit killer

Insight: Furniture generates \$742K in sales — second highest — but only \$18K profit. That is a 2.5% margin. Tables alone loses \$17,725 despite \$736K in sales.

Recommendation:

- Cap Furniture discounts at 15% immediately
- Review Tables pricing — losing money despite high sales volume
- Evaluate discontinuing Tables if losses continue after 2 quarters

FINDING 3 — Three sub-categories are actively losing money

Insight: Tables (-\$17,725), Bookcases (-\$3,472) and Supplies (-\$1,189) lose a combined \$22,386 annually while consuming resources.

Recommendation:

- Conduct urgent discount audit on Tables, Bookcases and Supplies
- Eliminate discounts above 20% on these sub-categories
- Discontinue products if losses persist after price correction

FINDING 4 — West region is the growth engine

Insight: West leads with \$725K sales and \$108K profit — highest of all regions. South is weakest at \$391K sales and \$46K profit.

Recommendation:

- Study West region sales practices and replicate in South
 - Assign additional sales resources to South region
 - Investigate why South profit margin lags behind other regions
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FINDING 5 — Q4 is the revenue opportunity

Insight: November is the single highest sales month. September–December accounts for approximately 40% of annual revenue, showing strong seasonal demand.

Recommendation:

- Increase inventory and staffing ahead of Q4 every year
- Launch marketing campaigns in August to capture early buyers
- Ensure supply chain is prepared for November peak demand